Training Evidence: Communications Report

Installation and user guide for the Moodle plugin

Plugin · local_efcomms

Version 0.37.3 · Works with Moodle 5.1 to 5.3

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PART 1

Quick start

The essentials to have the Communications Report up and running in a few minutes.

What it is and what it is for

It audits a course's **communications**, what **students** and **tutors** write in **forums** and **messaging**, and presents them in an **exportable report** (PDF, Excel and CSV), built to evidence **tutoring** in any **training that has to be proven**: for Spain's FUNDAE® training scheme (formación bonificada) and for any grant, client or compliance audit.

- Two views: **Students** and **Tutors**, with filters by period, group and participation.
- **Three levels** of detail, set by permission: counters, excerpt or full content.
- **Access log (GDPR)**: a record of who viewed which communication.
- **Immediate** and **bulk** exports (the bulk one runs in the background), plus links to related reports.

Minimum requirements

- **Moodle 5.1, 5.2 or 5.3**, with administrator rights to install plugins.
- A user profile field for the **ID number** (by default `dni` ; not case-sensitive and configurable) and the course fields `fecha_inicio` / `fecha_final` (see Part 2).
- It is a **sibling** of `local_efreport` , the Training Evidence Report: if you already have it, this plugin **reuses the same fields**.
- `local_mail` is **optional** (soft dependency): if it is installed, its internal mail is audited too.

Install in 3 steps

1. In **Site administration → Plugins → Install plugins**, upload the file `local_efcomms_vX.zip` .
2. Click **Install** and, on the database upgrade screen, **Continue**.
3. Done: every course now has the **Communications Report** (in the course's "Reports" tab, with "More" as the fallback).

Minimum setup and your first report

1. Review the **site settings** once: report title, data protection notice, truncated text length and the ID number field (Part 2, §4).
2. Decide **who sees which level** by assigning the capabilities to roles (§6). By default, teachers see the **counters**.
3. Go into a course → **"Reports"** tab → **"Training Evidence: Communications Report"**.
4. Choose the **Students** or **Tutors** tab, apply filters and export to **PDF / Excel / CSV**.

3 key tips to get started

RECOMMENDED

Fill in the course **start and end date**: the report limits communications to that **period**, just like `local_efreport`. Leave the end date empty for an "open course".

PRIVACY FIRST

Communications are **personal data**. Give the **full content** level only to those who really need it; everyone else can work with **counters**. Every access is **logged**.

WATCH OUT

The report measures **teaching forums** (it excludes "Announcements") and **private messaging** between a student and their tutors, within the course **period**. Chats and conversations outside that pairing are not counted.

PART 2

Full guide

Every detail on use, settings, access levels and GDPR.

1 What the plugin does in detail

The plugin collects each course's **communications** and organises them into two mirror reports, so you can **evidence tutoring** to FUNDAE® or any other auditor:

Students tab

What each **student** has written: forum contributions and messages to their tutors. With counters, filters and an individual record.

Tutors tab

What each **tutor** (editing or non-editing teacher) has written: forum replies and messages to students. Same detail and exports.

Sources it audits:

- The course's **teaching forums** (the **"Announcements" forum is excluded**: it is not tutoring).
- Moodle's private **messaging** between each **student and their tutors**, within the period. A student counts as **contacted** only when the tutor **has written to them**; a student who wrote and got no reply is not (counted conservatively, as evidence requires). **Deleted** forum posts are not counted, and a discussion is dated by its **first post**, not by the latest reply.
- **local_mail** (internal mail), **only if it is installed**.

DATA FROM BEFORE THE INSTALLATION

The report **reads Moodle's history**: it also shows the messages and contributions that already existed **before** the plugin was installed. There is no need to start from scratch.

2 Requirements and custom fields

The report reuses the **same fields** as `local_efreport` (so if you already use it, there is nothing new to create). These are the ones we recommend when the training has to be proven:

Course custom fields — "General course data"

Field	Short name	Type	Locked
Training provider	centro_formacion	Short text	Yes
Tax ID (CIF in Spain)	cif	Short text	Yes
Tutor	tutor	Short text	Yes
Start date	fecha_inicio	Date and time	Yes
End date	fecha_final	Date and time	Yes
Duration in hours	duracion	Number	Yes

Course custom fields — "Training action identification"

Field	Short name	Type	Locked
File no.	expediente	Short text	Yes
Access	acceso	Short text	Yes
Training action no.	aaff	Short text	Yes
Training action title	denominacion_aaff	Short text	Yes
Delivery mode	modalidad	Dropdown menu	Yes

User profile field (ID number)

Field	Short name	Type	Locked
ID number / passport	dni (default)	Short text	**No**

THE ID FIELD IS FLEXIBLE

The short name does not have to be exactly `dni`:

- **Not case-sensitive:** `dni`, `DNI` or `Dni` all work the same.
- **Configurable:** if your site uses another name (`nif`, `documento`...), enter it in the site setting **"ID number profile field"** (§4). There is no need to rename the existing field.

3 Installation (web, manual and CLI)

Method 1 — Web interface (recommended)

1. **Site administration → Plugins → Install plugins**.
2. Drag the plugin ZIP in and click **Install plugin from the ZIP file**.
3. Confirm and **upgrade the database** when prompted.

Method 2 — Manual file copy

1. Unzip the file and copy the `efcomms` folder into `moodle/local/` (in Moodle 5.x, `public/local/`).
2. Go to **Site administration → Notifications** and follow the wizard.

Method 3 — Command line

Copy the folder and run:

```
php admin/cli/upgrade.php
```

> **TIP**
>
> After installing or changing language packs, run `php admin/cli/purge_caches.php` so everything shows up to date.

4 Site settings (administrator)

Go to **Site administration → Plugins → Local plugins → "Training Evidence: Communications Report"**. Each course can override several of these values.

Setting	What it does	Default
Report title	Heading of the report and of the exports.	"Communications Report".
Data protection notice	Notice shown when opening the literal content of communications.	Default text included.
Allow per-course notice	Lets each course set its own data protection notice.	Off.
Log access to message content	Records who views level 2 and 3 content.	On.
Truncated text length	Characters shown for each message at level 2.	50 characters.
Notification email (global)	Copy of the notice sent when a bulk export finishes.	Empty (the requester only).
Export retention (days)	Days the bulk export files are kept.	7 days.
ID number profile field	Short name of the user field holding the ID number (not case-sensitive).	`dni` (or `nif`, `documento`...).

5 Course settings

Inside the course, the **"Communications Report settings"** entry (requires the `local/efcomms:configure` capability). It lets you adjust, for that course:

- **"Use the site-wide settings for this course"** (inherit the site settings) or customise them.
- The course's own **Report title**.
- The **Truncated text length** for level 2.
- **Access logging** on or off (with a warning about the data protection implications of turning it off).
- The **notification email** for the course's bulk exports.
- The course's own **data protection notice**, **only if the administrator allows it** (a padlock otherwise).

> **TIP**
>
> Course setting changes are **audited** (who changed what and when), which is useful to demonstrate traceability in an audit.

6 The three access levels key

Because communications are personal data, the plugin grades what each person sees according to their **role**, through **capabilities**. Assign them in **Define roles** or per course:

1

Counters

How many contributions and messages there were, without seeing the content. It proves the activity while respecting privacy as much as possible.

Capability: `viewcounts`

2

Excerpt (truncated)

The first characters of each communication (50 by default). It gives context without exposing the full text.

Capability: `viewtruncated`

3

Full content

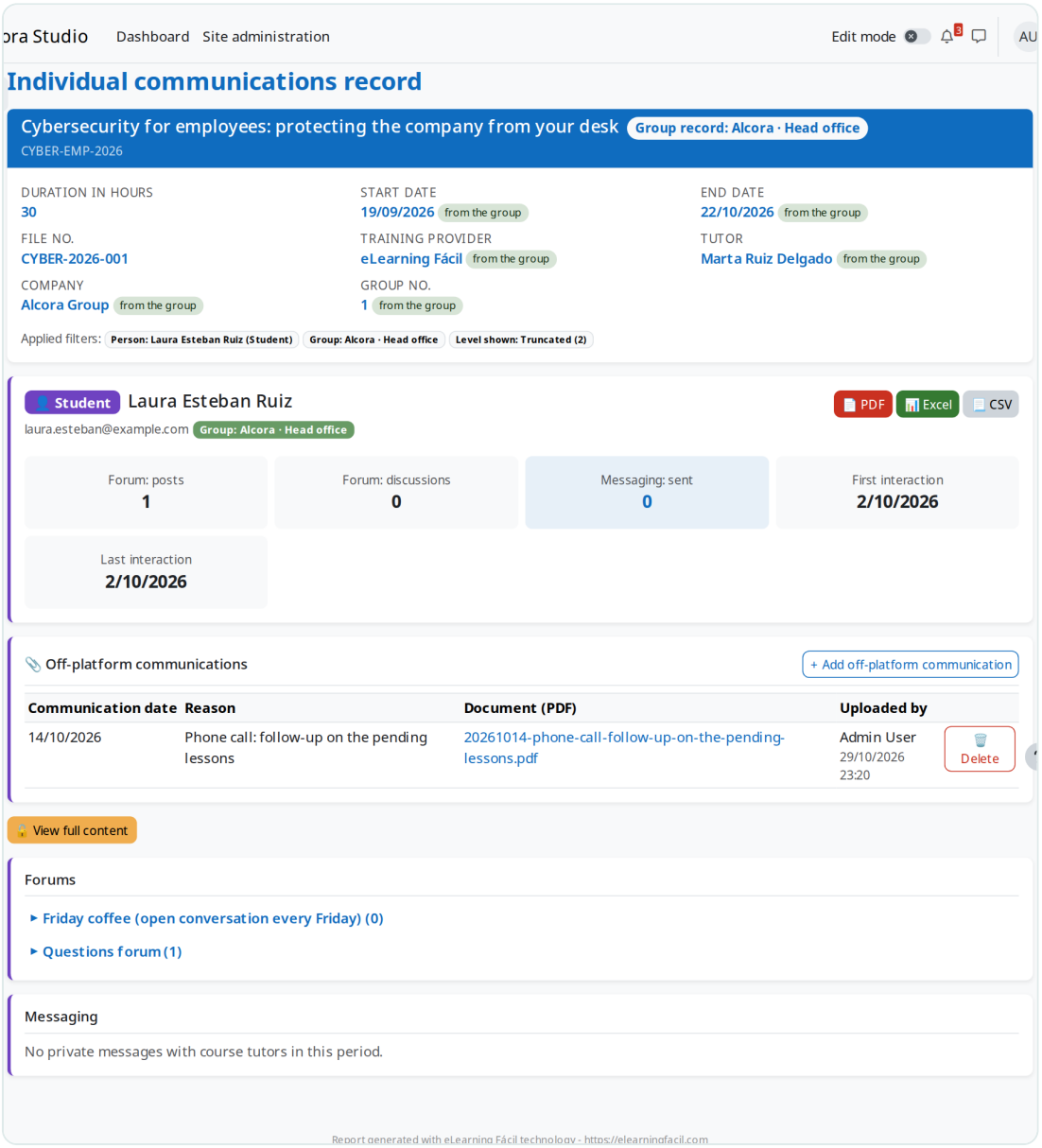
The literal text of forums and messaging. Maximum detail; the most sensitive under GDPR.

Capability: `viewfullcontent`

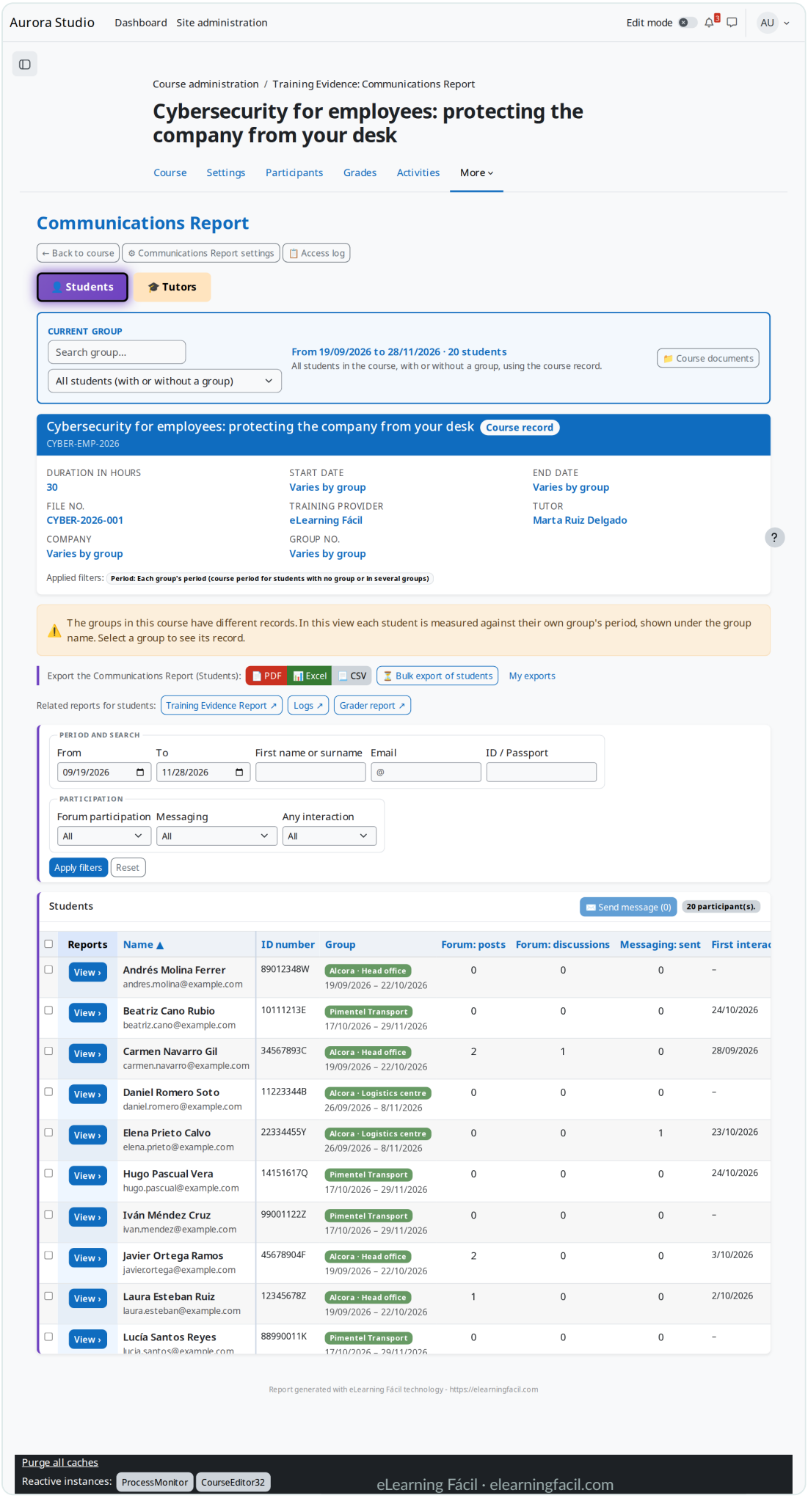
In addition, `local/efcomms:configure` lets you **configure** the report and view the **access log** (manager/administrator).

PROGRESSIVE DISCLOSURE (AND EVERYTHING IS LOGGED)

In the individual record, content opens **truncated** (level 2), and **that access is already logged**, because the excerpt shows part of the message. To see the full text (level 3) you click **"View full content"** and **accept the data protection notice**; that access is logged as **level 3**. So **both the excerpt (level 2) and the full content (level 3)** leave a trace.

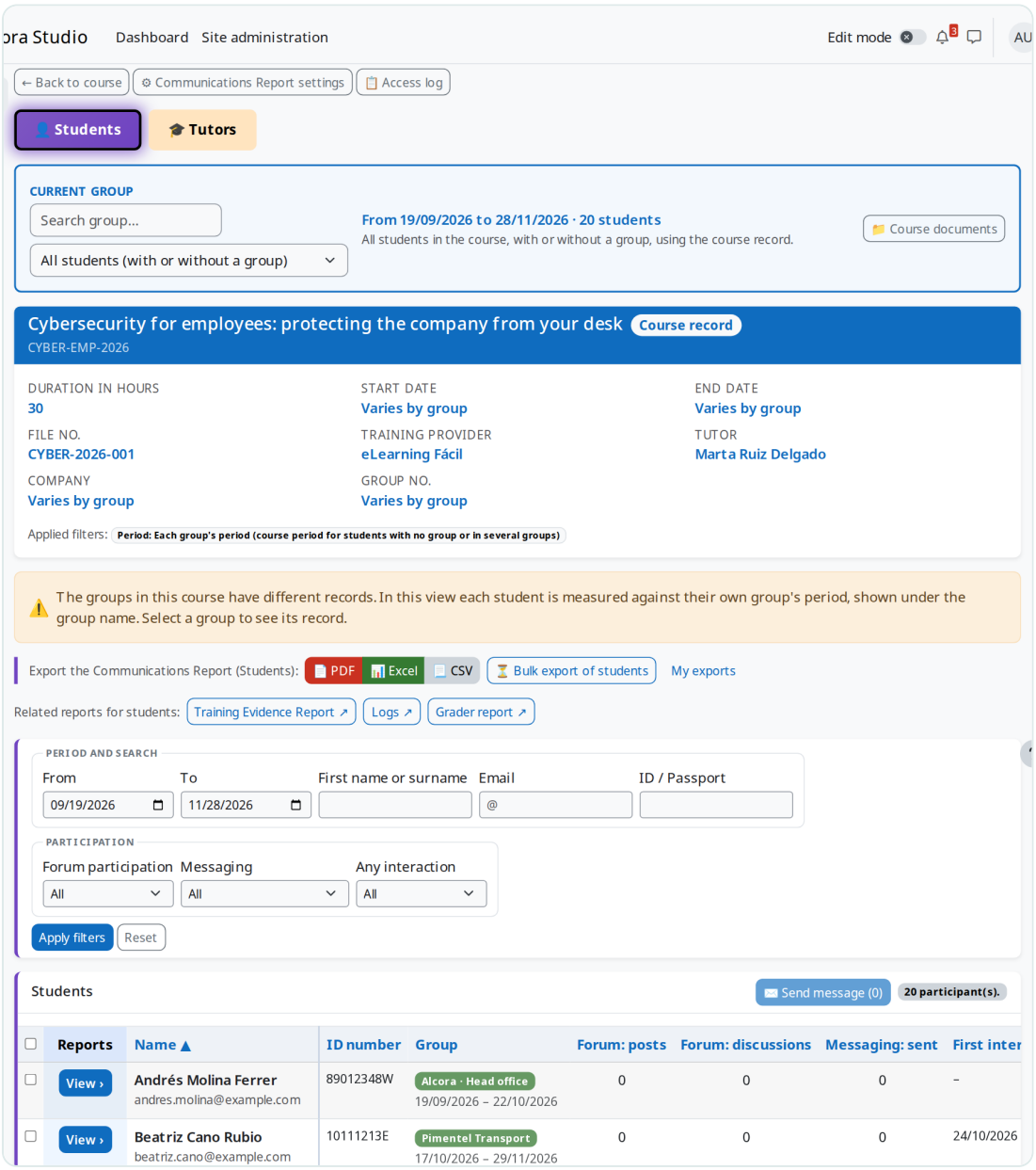


The record opens truncated (level 2); opening it already logs the access.


Aurora Studio
Dashboard
Site administration
Edit mode
AU
Course administration / Training Evidence: Communications Report
Cybersecurity for employees: protecting the company from your desk
Course
Settings
Participants
Grades
Activities
More
Communications Report
← Back to course
⚙ Communications Report settings
📋 Access log
👤 Students
🎓 Tutors
CURRENT GROUP
Search group...
All students (with or without a group)
From 19/09/2026 to 28/11/2026 · 20 students
All students in the course, with or without a group, using the course record.
📁 Course documents
Cybersecurity for employees: protecting the company from your desk
Course record
CYBER-EMP-2026
DURATION IN HOURS
30
START DATE
Varies by group
END DATE
Varies by group
FILE NO.
CYBER-2026-001
TRAINING PROVIDER
eLearning Fácil
TUTOR
Marta Ruiz Delgado
COMPANY
Varies by group
GROUP NO.
Varies by group
Applied filters:
Period: Each group's period (course period for students with no group or in several groups)
The groups in this course have different records. In this view each student is measured against their own group's period, shown under the group name. Select a group to see its record.
Export the Communications Report (Students):
PDF
Excel
CSV
Bulk export of students
My exports
Related reports for students:
Training Evidence Report ↗
Logs ↗
Grader report ↗
PERIOD AND SEARCH
From
09/19/2026
To
11/28/2026
First name or surname
Email
@
ID / Passport
PARTICIPATION
Forum participation
All
Messaging
All
Any interaction
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Apply filters
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ID number
Group
Forum: posts
Forum: discussions
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andres.molina@example.com
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beatriz.cano@example.com
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Pimentel Transport
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carmen.navarro@example.com
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ivan.mendez@example.com
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Report generated with eLearning Fácil technology - https://elearningfacil.com
Purge all caches
Reactive instances:
ProcessMonitor
CourseEditor32

Clicking “View full content” shows the data protection notice and the whole text (level 3); that access is logged.

7 Using the report



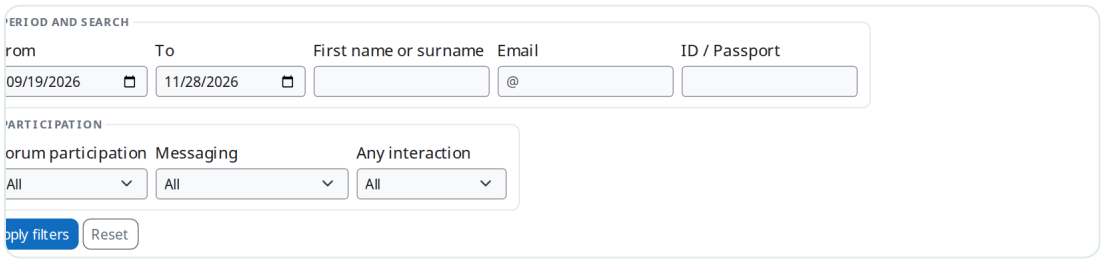
Students (purple) and Tutors (orange) tabs, with filters and activity columns. The table works like the one in the Training Evidence Report: a horizontal scroll bar at the top and at the bottom, the “Reports” and “Name” columns fixed, and the width of “Name” adjusted by dragging the edge of its heading (the browser remembers it).

Filters, as in the Training Evidence Report new

The filters work the same way as in the Training Evidence Report, so there is nothing new to learn:

- They are **grouped in blocks**: “Period and search”, “Participation” and “Profile fields”.
- The search has **one box for each thing**: first name or surname, email and ID number. As you type in one, an **x** appears to clear it.
- **Participation**: forums, messaging and **“Any interaction” (yes / no)**, to spot at a glance who has not written anything. In the Tutors tab, also **“Contacted any student” (yes / no)**.

- **Profile fields**: the student profile fields chosen as a filter or as a column (workplace, order number…). With the Training Evidence Report installed they are **the same as there** (one selection for both reports, in its site settings and in the course settings); without it, you choose them in this plugin's settings and in each course's settings. They also appear in the list exports. The lists also include **Moodle's standard fields** (ID number, institution, department, city, country, phones, description), marked "(Moodle field)", which can be mixed with the custom ones, in the order of the list (custom fields first, then standard); the country is filtered by name or code.
- Anyone without the management details permission (the auditor role) only sees, and can only filter by, the fields marked as "Profile fields the auditor sees". And whoever is looking (auditor, teacher or manager), the report never shows a field that Moodle itself would hide from them in the course: identity fields (ID number, institution, department, phones) as on the participants page, that is, the field in "Show user identity" and the `moodle/site:viewuseridentity` permission (the manager sees ID number, institution and department in any case); city, country and description according to "Hide user fields"; and custom fields according to their own visibility. The country is filtered by part of its name or by its two-letter code.



The three filter blocks of the Students tab.

- **Tabs Students** (purple) and **Tutors** (orange), told apart by colour.
- **Filters**: period (pre-filled with the course dates), group, search by name/ID number/email and participation. Click **"Apply filters"**.
- **Sorting** by any column (click the heading).
- **Individual record** (the "View ›" button in the **Reports** column): counters, breakdown by forum and messaging, with the option to **"View full content"** (level 3).
- A uniform **identification block** (course details, "Generated on…", applied filters) on screen and **inside** every export.
- **Related reports**: links to the Training Evidence Report (`local_efreport`), Logs and Grader report.
- **Separate groups**: if the course is in that mode, teachers without the `moodle/site:accessallgroups` permission only see people in **their own groups** (lists, records and exports). Managers and auditors with access to all groups see the whole course.

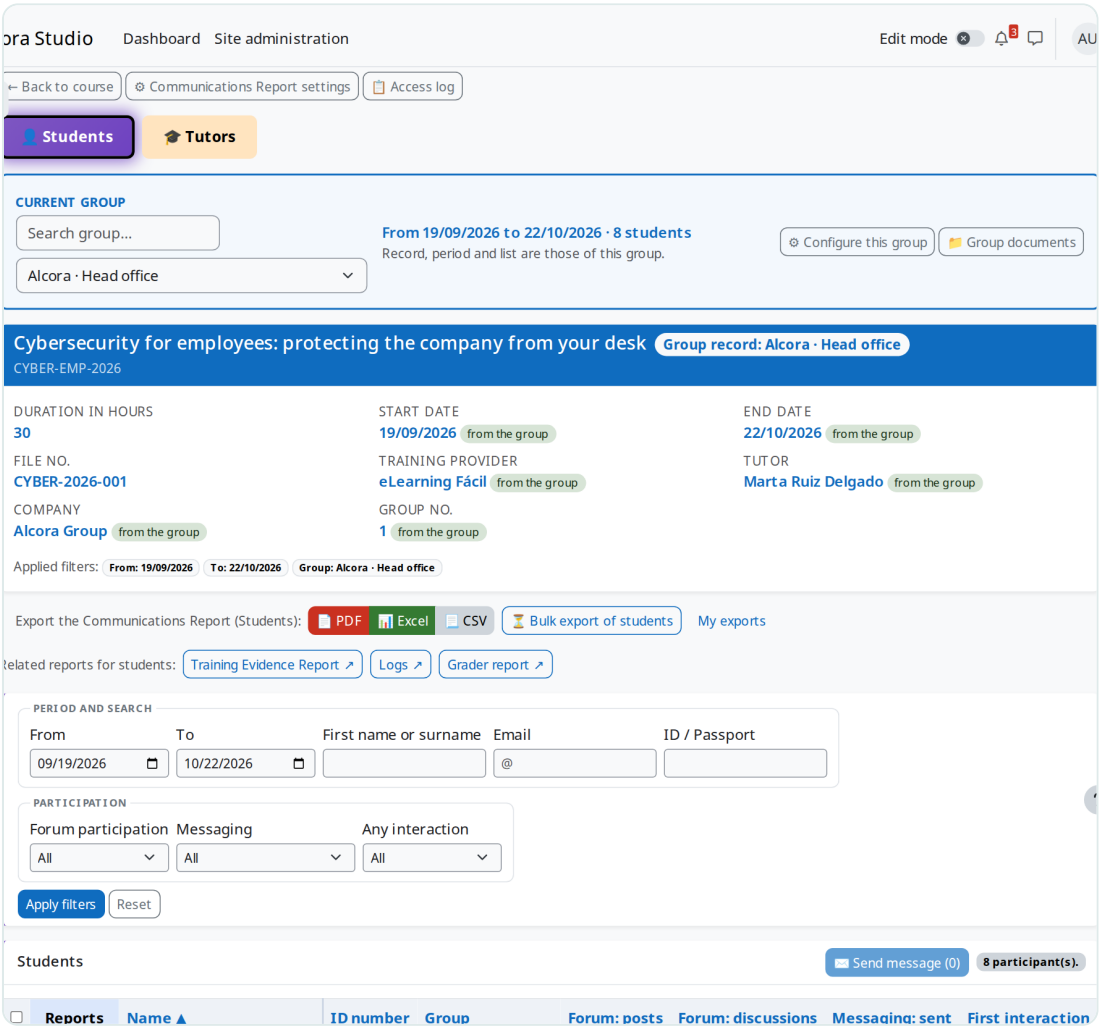
Several actions or companies in one course: the group record new

If each group in the course is a different training action or company, enable **"Per-group records"** (with the Training Evidence Report installed it is that plugin's setting; without it, it is in this plugin's settings). From then on:

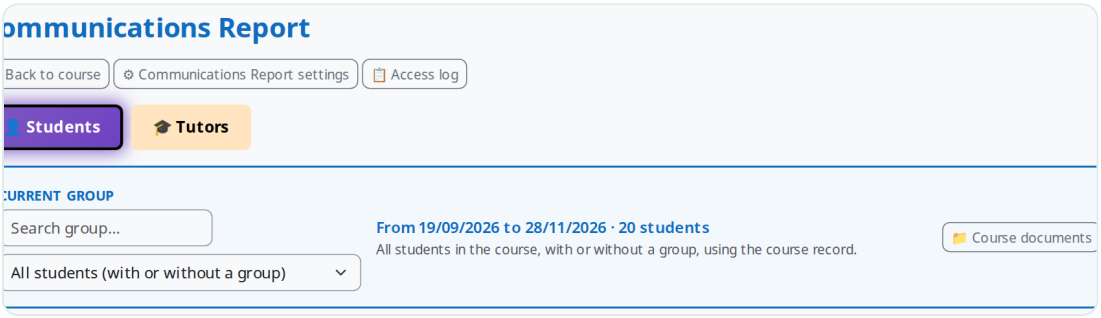
- Above the report you get the **"Current group"** box, the same as in the Training Evidence Report: a drop-down with a search box, the period and how many people there are. The group stops being just another filter: it is **the view**. When you pick one, the header becomes **that group's record** (the "Group record" label

and the “from the group” mark on whatever the group changes), the dates are **the group’s** and so is the list. The same applies in the exports and in each person’s record.

- Whatever the group leaves empty is inherited from the course.
- **“No group”** lists those who are in no group, with the course record.
- With **all students** and differing records, a notice says so, the header shows “Varies by group” on what changes and **each student is measured against their own group’s period**, shown under the group name (no group, or several groups with different periods: the course period). If you set dates by hand in the filters, they apply to everyone.
- If the course measures by **enrolment dates** (the “Report period” setting of the Training Evidence Report), this report counts each student within their own enrolment and a column shows which it is. In both cases the exports carry the “Period” line and a column with each student’s period, including the bulk export.
- **“Configure this group”** takes you to where the group record is filled in: with the Training Evidence Report installed, to its configuration page; without it, to Moodle’s “Edit group settings”.
- With **separate groups**, someone who only sees their own groups never sees another group’s record or period; if they have just one, they go straight into it.



A selected group: its period and its students in the box, “Group record” in the header and “from the group” on the data the group changes.



All students with differing records: “Varies by group”, the notice and each student’s period under their group.

Group fields are created once in **Site administration → Courses → Group custom fields**, with the same short name as the course fields, and filled in under “Edit group settings”. Without the Training Evidence Report, the short names of the dates (`fecha_inicio` , `fecha_final`) and of the duration are changed in this plugin’s settings; with it, its own settings apply.

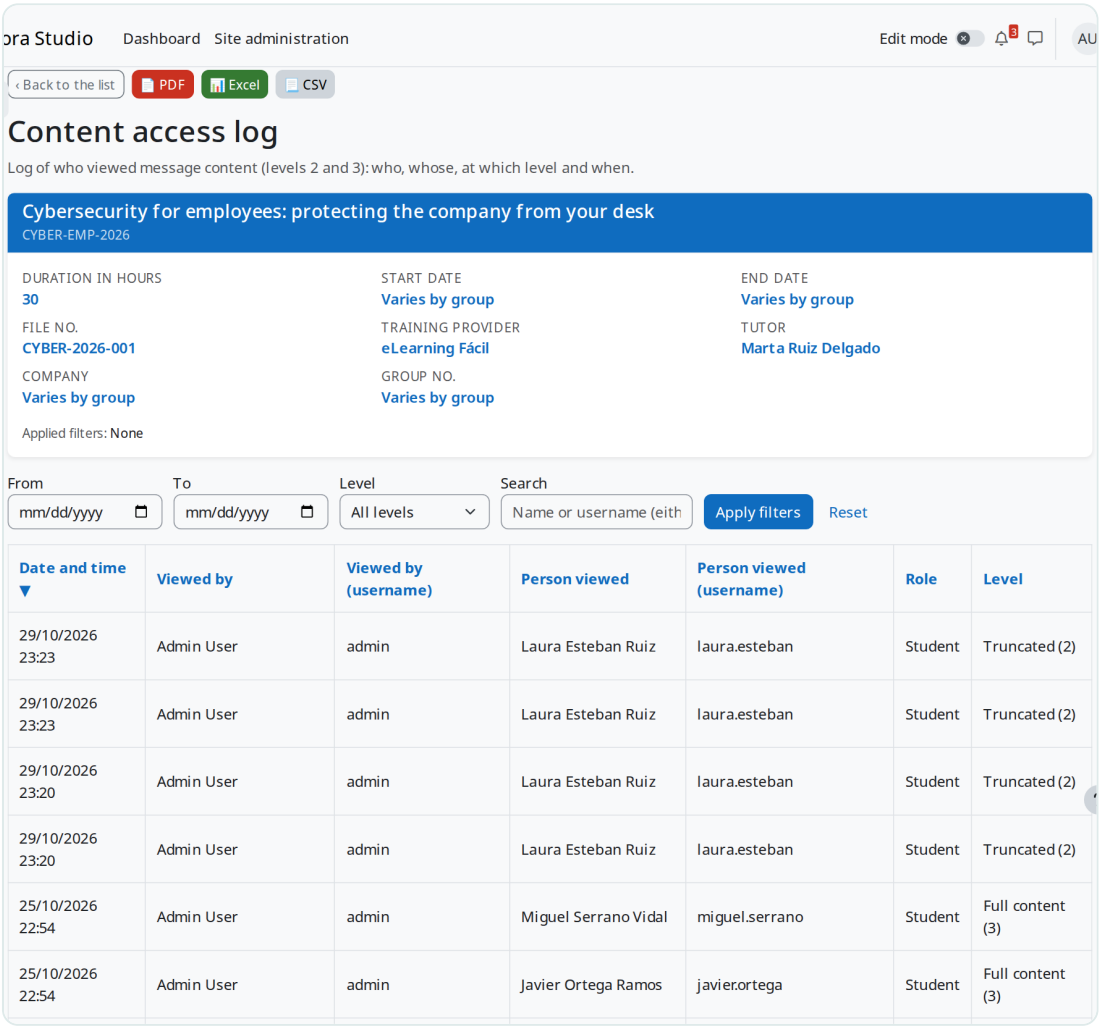
8 Access log (GDPR) key

The **access log** (requires `configure`) is a small report of its own with **two tabs**:

- **Content views (levels 2 and 3)**: each view of the **content** of a person’s communications: who looked, at whom, at which level of detail and when.
- **List queries (level 1)**: who opened the report or exported it (events from Moodle’s standard log). It also exports to **PDF/Excel/CSV**, with the same course identification as the other reports.

The content tab shows:

- **Who** viewed (name and *username*) and **whom** (the person whose communications were viewed).
- **Which level** (2 or 3) and **when**.
- With **filters** (dates, search, level) and **export** to CSV/Excel/PDF.



Each view is recorded with its level: “Truncated (2)” or “Full content (3)”.

WHY IT MATTERS

In an audit, this log proves **who accessed personal data and when**: a guarantee of traceability and of compliance with the GDPR accountability principle.

9 Exports

Immediate

From the list or the record: **PDF**, **Excel** or **CSV**. The PDF carries the course details, the applied filters and a **branded footer**. Ideal for one-off evidence.

Bulk (with details)

Every communication in the tab. It is generated in the **background** and downloaded from **“My exports”**; you are notified in your **Moodle notifications** and by **email**. It is **Excel** (for performance).

HOW THE BULK EXPORT WORKS

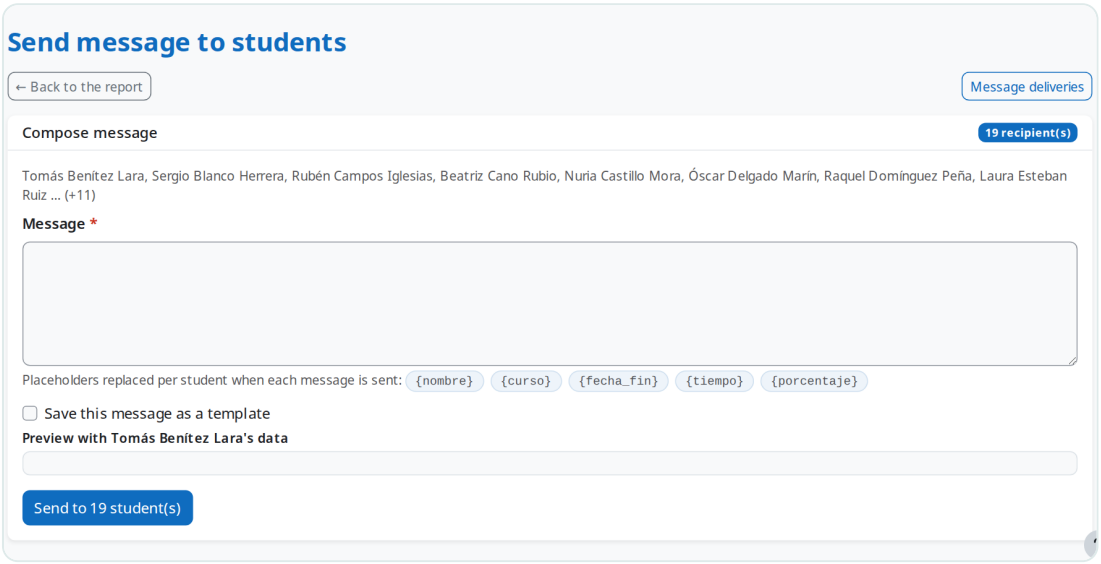
When you request it, the server queues it and a scheduled task prepares it. When it is ready, you are notified; the file is kept for a limited time (**7 days** by default) and then deleted. The bulk export is **level 3** and **logs the access** for every person included.

MIND THE VOLUME

The bulk export dumps **everything**: use it when the training action closes. For day-to-day queries, use the filters and the immediate export.

10 Messaging from the list new

From the list (Students or Tutors) you can **select people** with the checkboxes (the heading one selects everyone filtered) and click **"Send message"**.

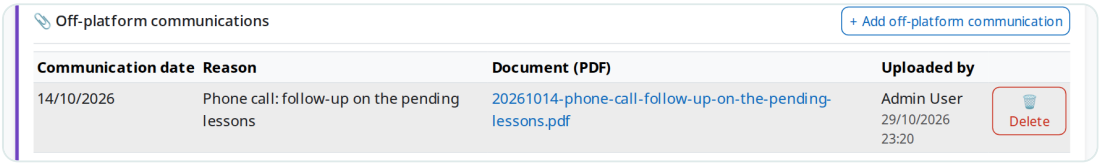


Compose with reusable **templates** (site and course) and per-recipient **placeholders**: {nombre} (first name), {curso} (course), {fecha_fin} (end date)...

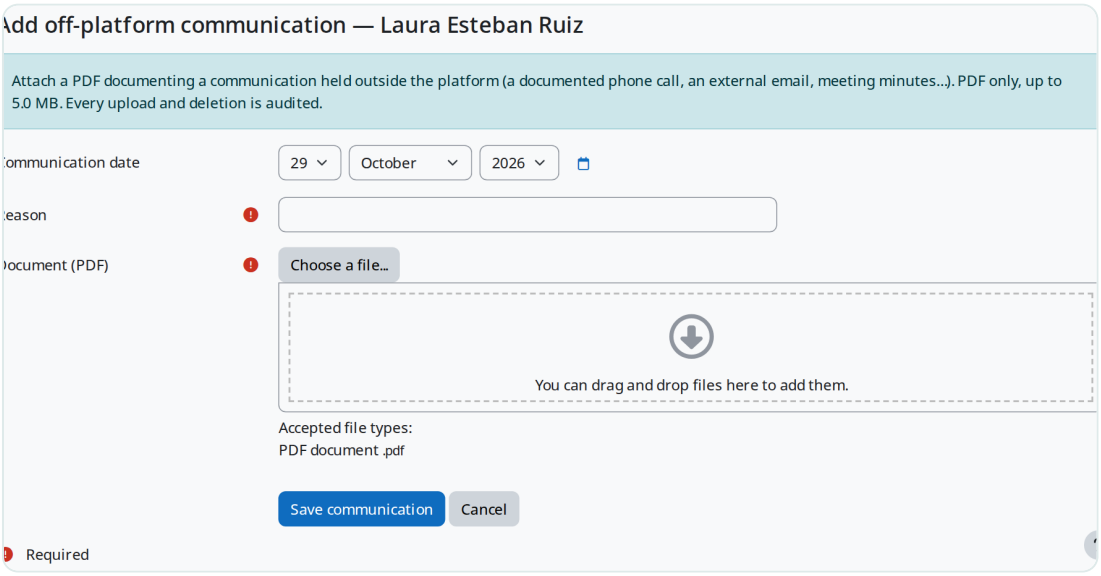
- It uses Moodle's **internal messaging**: everything is on record (and auditable by this very report, which closes the loop).
- Large batches go through a **paced queue**: the system respects your hosting's limits.
- Every batch is **audited**: who sent it, the text and a snapshot of the filters used.

11 Off-platform communications new

Not all communication with students happens inside the platform: a documented phone call, an authorised external email or the minutes of a meeting are also part of the training file. From the **student's record**, managers and teachers can attach them as **off-platform communications** in PDF, with their **date** and **reason**.



In the student's record: the list of off-platform communications and the **"+ Add off-platform communication"** button (managers and teachers only).

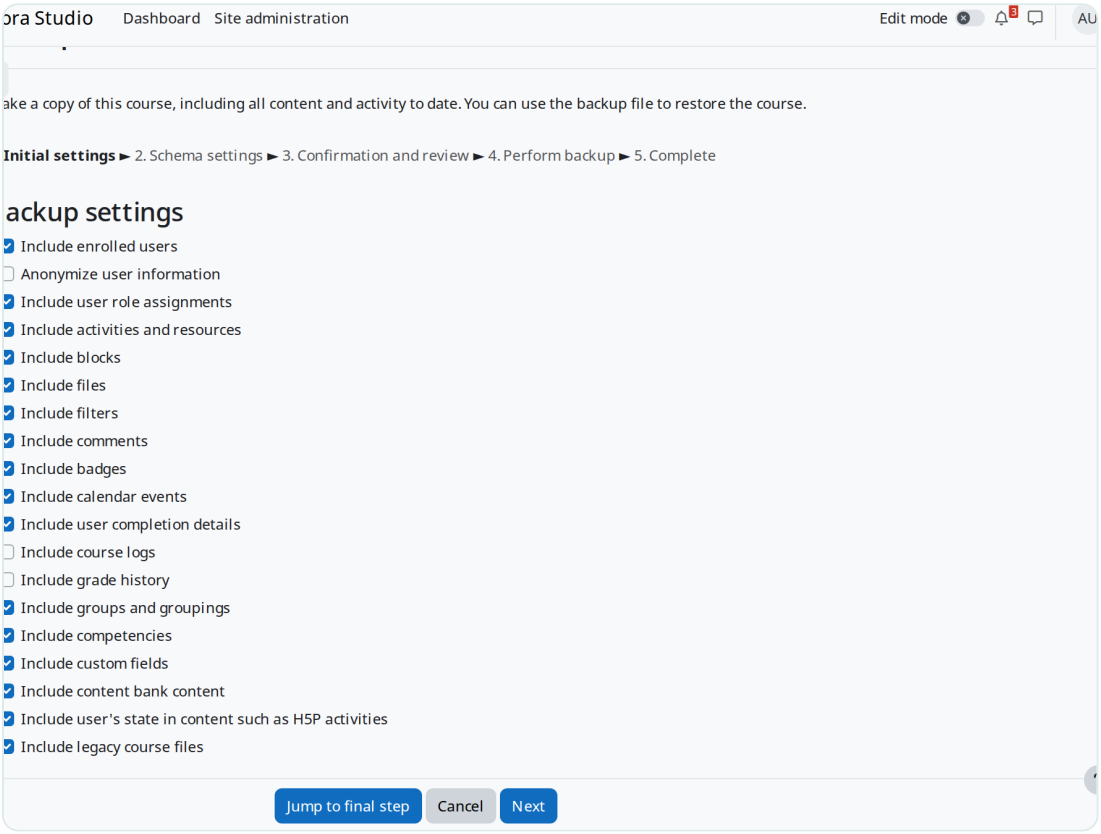


The form asks for the **communication date** (not the upload date), the **reason** and the **PDF** (.pdf only, up to 5 MB by default; the limit is changed in the site settings).

- The file is renamed automatically to `{fecha}-{motivo}.pdf` (date and reason): identifiable even outside the platform, and ready for the downloadable training file.
- **Every upload and every deletion is audited** (who, whose, which file and when).
- Permission: `local/efcomms:manageattachments` (managers and teachers). The auditor does **not** have it: they can see the attachments in the record, but not add or delete them.
- In backups, the attachments travel with **"Include enrolled users"**; their audit trail, with **"Include course logs"**.
- With **separate groups**, teachers can only view and manage them in the records of their own groups.
- new The **student's PDF record** includes an **index table of their off-platform communications** (date · reason · file name): when you download it, or when the dossier packages it, the attachments folder has a clear cross-reference.

12 Backup and restore new

The plugin takes part in **course backups** (.mbz). The rule, in one line: **settings and templates: always · audit trails: with "Include course logs"**.



With **"Include course logs"** ticked, the access log, the settings audit trail and the export history (the trail, not the expired files) travel too: the same box that governs Moodle's own logs.

- Without that box, the audit trail **stays on the source site** (where it must be kept or exported).
- The communications themselves (forums, messages) are core data with their own backup rules: forums travel with the course; personal messages never do.
- Restoring the same backup twice **does not duplicate anything**.
- If you restore **into an existing course**, tick **"Overwrite course configuration"**: otherwise Moodle skips the step that brings in the plugin's data (attachments, trails, templates) and nothing arrives. This is how Moodle behaves, not the plugin.
- **Deleting a course's contents** to reuse it (restoring on top with "Delete the contents of the existing course and then restore") also deletes the evidence of that edition: attachments, trails, exports and message batches. Settings and templates are kept.

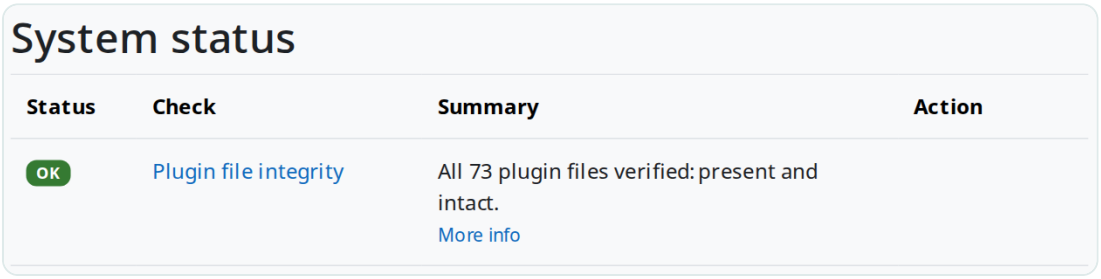
When a course is deleted, its communications go with it

Since version 0.26.0, **deleting a course** also deletes all the communications it recorded (level 1 queries, messages, attachments and audit trail). Before letting you delete it, the confirmation shows a **warning** if the course has communications.

> **TRAINING THAT MAY BE AUDITED: DOSSIER BEFORE DELETING**
>
> The retention requirement (in Spain, FUNDAE® asks for 4 years) is met with the **dossier** or the exports generated **before** the course is deleted, not with invisible data in the database.

13 Installation integrity check new

Every zip includes an **integrity manifest**. After installing or upgrading, open **Site administration → Reports → System status**:



The "Plugin file integrity" row must show **OK**. If your hosting lost or emptied a file during installation, it shows an **Error with the exact list**: reinstall the plugin (if it happens again, extract the zip with your hosting's file manager) and purge the caches.

14 Access for the auditor

The auditor usually needs to **view** the communications without being able to **change** anything. The answer is a **custom read-only role**.

- Grant them the right **level**: `viewcounts` (counters), `viewtruncated` (excerpt) or `viewfullcontent` (full content).
- Decide according to your privacy policy: for many audits the **counters** are enough; the **full content** is more sensitive (and is logged).
- Moodle **does not ship** an "auditor" role: you set it up in **Define roles**.

> **THE AUDITOR ROLE, READY-MADE**
>
> Use the auditor role preset shipped with the Training Evidence Report plugin (`local_efreport` 2.49.1 or later: `roles/inspectorfundae_en.xml` , role "Auditor"). It is set up for the whole family of plugins (including the communications level we agree on) and its short name is `inspectorfundae` . Import it once per site: **Define roles → "Add a new role" → Use role preset** (new role) or **"Reset"** (existing role), and assign it **in each course** to be audited.

> **IMPORTANT: PLUGIN FIRST, THEN THE ROLE**
>
> Upload the role XML **after installing the plugin**: the role refers to its capabilities, and they must already exist. If you install another plugin later, **Reset** the role with the XML again.

15 More plugins by eLearning Fácil

This report is sold on its own and is also part of the **Training Evidence Pack**. Around it there is a family of eLearning Fácil plugins that work the same way, together or on their own:

Training Evidence Pack

Training evidence, ready for an audit. The Time, Activity & Evaluation Report with a reliable clock (inactivity, period, 75% assessments), this Communications Report, the Group Dossier in a ZIP you can keep for as long as your scheme requires (4 years under Spain's FUNDAE® scheme), the Report Links block and the Time Restriction, which opens activities by active time. With a group record for several training groups or companies in one course.
elearningfacil.com/pack-fundae-moodle

Also in the Pack

Training Evidence: Automatic Alerts (`local_efalerts`) for the student and the tutor (not started, drop-out, final stretch, assessments, certificate deadline); **Training Evidence: Course Ready Check** (`local_efready`), which checks the course meets the requirements before it starts; and **Training Evidence: My Progress** (`block_efprogress` , free), the block where each student sees their time and what is left.

Class Manager

Sell courses by seat and rent out classrooms on your Moodle. Your client enrols their own students from their course; you set the seats and the access period, and each student gets their access by email without anyone sending it by hand.
elearningfacil.com/alquila-moodle-por-aulas-plugin

Bulk Certificate Manager

Issue and download a course's certificates in one go (Workplace and Custom certificate), with filters for who qualifies, and keep a record of delivery.

Training Evidence: Time Clock (free)

Measures each student's real active time in the course. It is the way in: if you install the Pack later, everything measured is kept.

Find out more

They all work the same way, together or on their own. You can see them, try them and request them at **elearningfacil.com** · **info@elearningfacil.com**.

16 Recommendations for audits and GDPR

- Set the course **period** (`fecha_inicio` / `fecha_final`) so communications are scoped properly.
- Keep **access logging on**: it is your evidence of who viewed personal data.
- Apply the principle of **least privilege**: give the full content level only to those who need it.
- Review the **data protection notice** so it identifies the data controller (the training provider).
- Export to **PDF** when each training action closes, as evidence of tutoring.

17 Frequently asked questions

Symptom	Cause / solution
I can't see the content of the messages	You have level 1 (counters). To see text you need the `viewtruncated` or `viewfullcontent` capability.
The "View full content" button does not appear	Your role lacks the `viewfullcontent` capability (level 3).
A tutor is missing from the Tutors tab	Only teacher roles (editing and non-editing) enrolled in the course count as tutors.
A student's communications are missing	Only those exchanged with their tutors and within the course period are counted; check the dates.
I don't get the bulk export notice	Check your notification preferences and email; the bulk export notifies you in your Moodle notifications and by email when it finishes.
The ID number does not show	The user profile field is missing, or its short name does not match; enter it in "ID number profile field".
Bulk exports never arrive	Check that cron is running; the scheduled task prepares them in the background and notifies you in your Moodle notifications and by email.
I restored a course and the access log is not there	That is expected without the "Include course logs" box: the audit trail stays on the source site.
"Plugin file integrity" shows Error	Your hosting broke some files during installation: reinstall the plugin from its zip and purge the caches.

18 Support

ELEARNING FÁCIL

Questions, or need it adapted to your platform? Write to us at **elearningfacil.com**. We'll be happy to help you keep your training audit-ready.

Guide for the `local_efcomms` plugin · version 0.37.3 · © 2026 eLearning Fácil. Works with Moodle 5.1 to 5.3.

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